

transmission and distribution, power generation offers the largest opportunity through Independent Power Plants (IPPs), captive power plants and merchant power plants.

As part of the overall power reform strategy, the Government is pushing ahead with its plan to build a national power grid which will be in a position to relay power effectively and efficiently from regions of surplus to deficit areas and load centres. This is expected to ease peak-time shortages and make better use of available generating capacity.

Power has been recognised as one of the most important infrastructure sectors. The Government should treat the power sector at par with other infrastructure sectors and provide necessary policy and fiscal support so as to achieve "electricity for all at affordable cost".

The objective of the 11th Plan is "faster and more inclusive growth" and with the

Government targeting a GDP growth of 10 per cent by the end of the 11th Plan, it is imperative that the power sector should grow at a rate not be less than 15 per cent per annum.

India has the second largest road network in the world, with 3.5 million km of roads. Only 2 per cent of Indian roads are National Highways. The density of roads in India is comparable to developed countries such as the United States. However, India's road quality is well below global standards. The poor quality of roads results in inefficiencies. The road sector has experienced challenges across all dimensions. The sector experienced acute challenges as private sector players opted not to bid for available tenders. The lack of interest from the private sector was driven both by questions on the attractiveness of the projects as well as NHAI's own variable policies with respect to bidding criteria.

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